



Current Topics in Marine Science, MBI F603

1 Credit
Fall, 2024

Land Acknowledgement

- The University of Alaska Fairbanks' (UAF) Troth Yeddha' campus in Fairbanks, Alaska is located on the unceded, traditional homelands of the Lower Tanana Dene.
- UAF's College of Fisheries and Ocean Sciences campus in Juneau, Alaska is located on the unceded territories of the Áak'w K'wáan.
- A map of Indigenous Peoples and Languages of Alaska can be found [here](#).

COVID-19 statement

Students should keep up-to-date on the university's policies, practices, and mandates related to COVID-19 by regularly checking [this website](#). Students are expected to adhere to the university's policies, practices, and mandates related to public health. While the formal COVID-19 response has ended, the advice that was true throughout the pandemic remains true now – please stay home if you are sick, cover your cough, and wash your hands to help keep our university communities healthy.

General Information

<i>Instructor:</i>	Kristen Gorman	<i>Office Location:</i>	Irving II, room 231
<i>Email:</i>	kgorman@alaska.edu	<i>Office Hours:</i>	Tuesdays 11:00 am - 12:00 pm online via Zoom, anytime by appointment. Office hours via Zoom: https://alaska.zoom.us/join/tZOvdu-vqjOqHtTzGRE-hM87RIPpyPJLIJqE
<i>Telephone:</i>	907-474-5930	<i>*Course Type:</i>	Lecture
<i>**Course Location:</i>	Canvas is our Learning Management System.	<i>Meeting Time:</i>	Online, Asynchronous

Additional General Information

- As this course's instructor, I respectfully acknowledge Alaska's First Peoples and their long history of living in deep connection with their land and water, and the historical and ongoing legacy of colonialism. As a life-long student, I am committed to learning about injustice, and working to improve equity in my professional and personal life.
- This course meets online asynchronously. **All students should register in advance** for the course's Zoom office hours in order to meet in person with the instructor if needed. After registering, you will receive a confirmation email containing information about joining the meeting, **you can save this information to your Google calendar to easily find the Zoom office hours link each week.**
- If you need assistance navigating Zoom or Canvas please contact your instructor or [UAF's eCampus Student Support](#).

Prerequisites and Proficiencies

None, graduate student standing and acceptance into the Master of Marine Studies program.



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Course description

This course is required for completion of the Master of Marine Studies degree. The purpose of this course is to introduce students to current topics in the marine sciences, and in particular the diversity of research programs led by faculty associated with UAF's Marine Biology Department.

In-depth Course description

This course is required for completion of the Master of Marine Studies degree. The purpose of this course is to introduce students to current topics in the marine sciences, and in particular the diversity of research programs led by faculty associated with UAF's Marine Biology Department. Through online lectures, reading material, and assignments, students will learn about an array of current topics in the marine sciences. Students will engage in online discussion about these topics with their fellow classmates and instructor, explore connections between featured topics, environmental policy, and current news and world events. Finally, students will prepare an oral presentation that introduces their course colleagues to their proposed area of study within the Master of Marine Studies program.

Course Readings/Materials

All reading materials will be provided to students. There is no required textbook.

Supplemental Course Readings/Materials

None.

Technology Requirements

The course requires regular access to a computer and the internet to view and download any online materials in [Canvas](#). At various points during the semester, you will need to download course material and upload completed assignments, as well as contribute to discussions. For the purposes of this course, **please use your @alaska.edu email account only for correspondence with the instructor**, or the Canvas inbox feature to ensure that you do not miss any important information about the course.

Course Goals

- To introduce students to the diversity of current topics in the marine sciences, including both ongoing research within the Marine Biology Department at UAF and other scientific topics relevant to the global ocean.
- To sharpen critical thinking, and written and oral communication skills, using current topics in the marine sciences, and conservation and management resource issues, as unifying themes of the course.
- To develop knowledge of current topics in marine science, the techniques used in marine science, and applications for the conservation and management of marine natural resources that hold important cultural value and protections at the Tribal, State, and Federal levels.

Student Learning Outcomes

By the end of the semester, students that have enrolled in this class will have the following:

1. Familiarity with current issues in the marine sciences both in Alaska and across the global ocean.
2. Ability to discuss the biological and ecological details of these current topics, the pertinent political, cultural, and socioeconomic dimensions of current topics in marine science, and factors important to the conservation and management of marine natural resources.
3. Capacity for communicating a proposed area of study within the Master of Marine Studies program to broad audiences.



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Instructional Methods

- Short (15-20 mins each), pre-recorded lectures will introduce students to the various current topics in marine science. Instructions regarding readings, assignments, discussions, and presentations will be addressed in these pre-recorded lectures and/or in the individual Module folders organized on the Canvas website. Student presentations of their proposed research area will be recorded and uploaded to the Canvas website to made available for other students to view and provide constructive peer-review.
- No synchronous meetings are required although students are encouraged to meet with their instructor as needed via Zoom (i.e., during office hours, etc).
- Assignments and coursework consist of viewing pre-recorded lectures, reading assigned materials, completing assignments, engaging in peer discussion, and developing an oral presentation of a proposed project for the Master of Marine Studies program. All assignments will be submitted using the Canvas website for this course, see weekly module assignment/discussion submission links.

Explanation of Student Effort

Students are expected to attend 1 hour of lecture/discussion each week, and spend another 2-3 hours each week reading, or preparing assignments and presentations. In general, students should expect to spend about 3 hours each week on this course.

Tentative Course Calendar

Date	Assignment Title	Points or %	SLO
Week 1, (Aug 26-30)	Welcome, Course orientation, Schedule, and Overview of topics.		1
Week 2, (Sept 2-6)	Broad Topic I: Ecosystem Change and the Global Ocean. Assignment 1.	10	1, 3
Week 3, (Sept 9-13)	Assignment 1 due. Monday, Sept 9, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 3, (Sept 9-13)	Umanzor Lab – Mariculture (experimental marine ecology, coastal management and resilience). Discussion 1.	10	1, 3
Week 4, (Sept 16-20)	Discussion 1 due. Monday, Sept 16, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 4, (Sept 16-20)	Konar Lab – Coastal Community Ecology (kelp to whales, scientific diving). Discussion 2.	10	1, 3
Week 5, (Sept 23-27)	Discussion 2 due. Monday, Sept 23, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 5,	Kelley Lab – Ocean Acidification (experimental marine	10	1, 3



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(Sept 23-27)	ecology, global change, organismal response). Discussion 3.		
Week 6, (Sept 30-Oct 4)	Discussion 3 due. Monday, Sept 30, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 6, (Sept 30-Oct 4)	Wooller Lab – Stable Isotope Biogeochemistry and Paleoeecology (Arctic animals). Discussion 4.	10	1, 3
Week 7, (Oct 7-11)	Discussion 4 due. Monday, Oct 7, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 7, (Oct 7-11)	Mincks Lab – Benthic Ecology (food webs, molecular tools). Discussion 5.	10	1, 3
Week 8, (Oct 14-18)	Discussion 5 due. Monday, Oct 14, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 8, (Oct 14-18)	Iken Lab – Polar Marine Ecology (food webs, marine plants to fishes). Discussion 6.	10	1, 3
Week 9, (Oct 21-25)	Discussion 6 due. Monday, Oct 21, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 9, (Oct 21-25)	Broad Topic II: Genes to Ecosystems: Integrative Marine Ecology. Assignment 2.	10	1, 3
Week 10, (Oct 28-Nov 1)	Assignment 2 due. Monday, Oct 28, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 10, (Oct 28-Nov 1)	Gorman Lab – Integrative Marine Ecology (evolutionary and behavioral ecology, marine fishes and birds). Discussion 7.	10	1, 3
Week 11, (Nov 4-8)	Discussion 7 due. Monday, Nov 4, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 11, (Nov 4-8)	Hollmen Lab - Integrative Marine Ecology (disease and physiological ecology, epidemiology, marine birds). Discussion 8.	10	1, 3
Week 12, (Nov 11-15)	Discussion 8 due. Monday, Nov 11, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 12, (Nov 11-15)	Chenoweth Lab – Marine Mammal Ecology (energetics and foraging, distribution and movements, community-based	10	1, 3



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	research). Discussion 9.		
Week 13, (Nov 18-22)	Discussion 9 due. Monday, Nov 18, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 13, (Nov 18-22)	Horstmann Lab – Marine Mammal Physiological Ecology (Arctic species). Discussion 10.	10	1, 3
Week 14, (Nov 25-26)	Discussion 10 due. Monday, Nov 25, 2024 by 11:59 pm. <i>UAF Fall Break, Nov 27-29</i>	10	1, 2
Week 14, (Nov 25-26)	Broad Topic III: Alaska Marine Resource Management and Conservation. Assignment 3.	10	1, 3
Week 15, (Dec 2-6)	Assignment 3 due. Wednesday, Dec 4, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	10	1, 2
Week 15, (Dec 2-6)	Student Presentations. Peer-Review. Presentations and peer-review due Friday, Dec 6, 2024 by 11:59 pm.	30, 10	1, 2, 3

Evaluation

Lecture attendance/viewing	130 points (43%)
Broad topic assignments	30 points (10%)
Lecture topic discussions	100 points (34%)
Student presentation	30 points (10%)
Student presentation peer-review	10 points (3%)
Total	300 points (100%)

The number of earned total points will be used to determine final grades, which will follow:

A: 90-100

B: 80-89

C*: 70-79

D*: 60-69

F*: below 60

*In order for a graduate student to remain in good standing, GPA must not fall below a B (3.0). Thus, earning a grade of C or below in this course will adversely affect students' graduate standing.

Regular and Substantive Interaction (RSI)

To be compliant with federal law and Northwest Commission on Colleges and Universities (NWCCU) accreditation requirements, UAF faculty must ensure that all courses where faculty and students are not physically located in the same space for which students use federal financial aid have regular and substantive interaction (RSI) between students and instructors. Regular refers to interactions that are scheduled and predictable. Substantive refers to engaging students in teaching, learning, and assessment, consistent with course content.



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As your faculty member, I have included the following actions in this course to meet RSI requirements:

- Providing feedback on student's coursework
- Providing course-related information or answering questions
- Facilitating group discussions about content or competencies

An RSI Student Survey will be required of all students enrolled in this course and will be administered via Canvas within four weeks of the beginning of the course.

Course Policies

1.) Expectations On Progress In Coursework

- All assignments must be submitted on time. Late assignments will be marked down 5% for each day late.
- Please make sure you use your current @alaska.edu email address for all course correspondence. Check your e-mail messages regularly. Class information and any changes to the syllabus will be distributed through Canvas. Please note that the course schedule is "tentative", and the "actual" course schedule will be a living document that evolves over the semester (see Canvas).
- This course will require students to have access to the internet, a personal computer, and familiarity with online platforms such as Zoom and Canvas, as well as basic computer software programs such as Word, PowerPoint, and Excel.

2.) Attendance, Tardiness, Class Participation, Make-up Exams

- This course will be conducted entirely asynchronously. However, students are strongly encouraged to attend the instructor's Zoom office hours or schedule Zoom meetings with the instructor to discuss the course content, assignments, and overall student progress.
- Students are expected to participate in all aspects of the course including reviewing lectures and reading material, completing assignments, and contribute to peer-to-peer online discussions. Please be ready to engage with the course material, your fellow classmates, and the instructor. Students will be graded on their participation in discussion for a total of 37% of their final grade.
- Regular attendance, consistent participation, and timely submission of assignments are important for success in this course and generally building professional skills and abilities, this course seeks to develop and reinforce such etiquette.
- There are no exams in this course, thus make-up exams are not necessary.

3.) Plagiarism & Academic Integrity

Academic dishonesty applies to examinations, assignments, laboratory reports, fieldwork, practicums, creative projects, or other academic activities. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- a) presenting as their own the ideas or works of others without proper citation of sources;
- b) utilizing devices not authorized by the faculty member;
- c) using sources (including but not limited to text, images, computer code, and audio/video files) not authorized by the faculty member;
- d) providing assistance without the faculty member's permission to another student, or receiving assistance not authorized by the faculty member from anyone (with or without their knowledge);
- e) submitting work done for academic credit in previous classes, without the knowledge and advance permission of the current faculty member;
- f) acting as a substitute or utilizing a substitute;
- g) deceiving faculty members or other representatives of the university to affect a grade or to gain admission to a program or course;



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- h) fabricating or misrepresenting data;
- i) possessing, buying, selling, obtaining, or using a copy of any material intended to be used as an instrument of assessment in advance of its administration;
- j) altering grade records of their own or another student's work;
- k) offering a monetary payment or other remuneration in exchange for a grade; or
- l) violating the ethical guidelines or professional standards of a given program.

For more, see [Students Rights and Responsibilities](#).

Plagiarism is scientifically unethical and will not be tolerated in any way during this class.

4.) Classroom Etiquette and Student Behavior Guidelines.

- As with all members of the UAF community, the university requires online students to conduct themselves honestly and responsibly and to respect the rights of others. Students may not engage in behavior that disrupts the learning environment, violates the rights of others, or otherwise violates the student code of conduct, university rules, regulations, or procedures. More information about the UAF Student Code of Conduct and Student Rights and Responsibilities can be found [here](#).
- High ethical standards are expected of all students in this course. Violations of the UAF Student Code of Conduct will result in an immediate "F" grade. Additionally, violations of the Student Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action initiated by UAF.

5.) Extended Absence Policy

Extended absences are defined as missed classes or course work by students beyond what is permissible by the instructor's written course policies. Students may need to miss class and/or course work for a variety of reasons, including, but not limited to:

- bereavement
- personal illness or injury
- serious illness of a friend, family member or loved one
- military obligations
- jury service
- other emergency or obligatory situations

For more information, go to the student handbook or the Center for Students Rights and Responsibilities.

6.) UAF Incomplete Grade Policy:

Your instructor follows the University of Alaska Fairbanks Incomplete Grade Policy:

"The letter "I" (Incomplete) is a temporary grade used to indicate that the student has satisfactorily completed (C- or better) the majority of work in a course but for personal reasons beyond the student's control, such as sickness, has not been able to complete the course during the regular semester. Negligence or indifference are not acceptable reasons for an "I" grade."

For more information, see [the UAF regulations regarding grades](#).

Student Protections Statement

UAF embraces and grows a culture of respect, diversity, inclusion, and caring. Students at this university are protected against sexual harassment and discrimination (Title IX). Faculty members are designated as responsible employees which means they are required to report sexual misconduct. Graduate teaching assistants do not share the same reporting obligations. For more information on your rights as a student and the resources available to



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you to resolve problems, please go to the following site: <https://catalog.uaf.edu/academics-regulations/students-rights-responsibilities/>.

Disabilities Services Statement

I will work with the Office of Disability Services to provide reasonable accommodation to students with disabilities.

ASUAF Advocacy Statement

The Associated Students of the University of Alaska Fairbanks, the student government of UAF, offers advocacy services to students who feel they are facing issues with staff, faculty, and/or other students specifically if these issues are hindering the ability of the student to succeed in their academics or go about their lives at the university. Students who wish to utilize these services can contact the Student Advocacy Director by visiting the ASUAF office or emailing asuaf.office@alaska.edu.

Non-Discrimination Statement

The University of Alaska is an affirmative action/equal opportunity employer and educational institution. The University of Alaska does not discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, national origin, citizenship, age, sex, physical or mental disability, status as a protected veteran, marital status, changes in marital status, pregnancy, childbirth or related medical conditions, parenthood, sexual orientation, gender identity, political affiliation or belief, genetic information, or other legally protected status. The University's commitment to nondiscrimination, including against sex discrimination, applies to students, employees, and applicants for admission and employment. Contact information, applicable laws, and complaint procedures are included on UA's statement of nondiscrimination available at www.alaska.edu/nondiscrimination. For more information, contact:

UAF Office of Rights, Compliance and Accountability
1692 Tok Lane, 3rd floor, Constitution Hall, Fairbanks, AK 99775
907-474-7300
uaf-orca@alaska.edu

Student Academic Support

- Communication Center (907-474-7007, uaf-commcenter@alaska.edu, Student Success Center, 6th Floor Room 677 Rasmussen Library)
- Writing Center (907-474-5314, uaf-writing-center@alaska.edu, Student Success Center, 6th Floor Room 677 Rasmussen Library)
- UAF Math Services (907-474-7332, uaf-traccloud@alaska.edu)

Drop-in tutoring, Student Success Center, 6th Floor Room 677 Rasmussen Library)
1:1 tutoring (by appointment only), Chapman 210

Online tutoring (by appointment only) available
<https://www.uaf.edu/dms/mathlab/>, available at the Student Success Center

- Developmental Math Lab (Gruening 406, <https://www.uaf.edu/deved/math/>)



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- The Debbie Moses Learning Center at CTC (907-455-2860, 604 Barnette St, Room 120, <https://www.ctc.uaf.edu/student-services/student-success-center/>)
- For more information and resources, please see the Academic Advising Resource List <https://www.uaf.edu/advising/students/index.php>

Other Student Resources:

- Disability Services (907-474-5655, uaf-disability-services@alaska.edu, 110 Eielson Building)
- Student Health & Counseling [**free counseling sessions available**] (907-474-7043, <https://www.uaf.edu/chc/appointments.php>, Whitaker Building 2nd floor)
- Office of Rights, Compliance and Accountability (907-474-7300, uaf-orca@alaska.edu, 3rd Floor, Constitution Hall)
- Associated Students of the University of Alaska Fairbanks (ASUAF) or ASUAF Student Government (907-474-7355, asuaf.office@alaska.edu, Wood Center 119)

Title IX

University of Alaska Board of Regents have clearly stated in BOR Policy that discrimination, harassment and violence will not be tolerated on any campus of the University of Alaska. If you believe you are experiencing discrimination or any form of harassment including sexual harassment/misconduct/assault, you are encouraged to report that behavior. If you report to a faculty member or any university employee, they must notify the UAF Title IX Coordinator about the basic facts of the incident.

Your choices for reporting include:

1. You may access confidential counseling by contacting the UAF Health & Counseling Center at 907-474-7043;
2. You may access support and file a Title IX report by contacting the UAF Title IX Coordinator at 907-474-6600;
3. You may file a criminal complaint by contacting the University Police Department at 907-474-7721. For more information please visit the [UAF Department of Equity and Compliance](#) webpage.

Any UAF employee or volunteer who reasonably suspects or observes minor abuse or maltreatment is required to report the incident. Reporting procedures are available on the UAF Protection of Minors. Violation of this policy by employees shall be reported as well.

Emergency Notification Plan

Students will receive emergency notifications via phone or email. Please check your uonline account to confirm your emergency notification settings. for more information, please refer to the student handbook. In cases where you do not have access to your devices, as your instructor, I will take responsibility to relay any emergency notifications.